



Liquid lens Mi Mix teased

Xiaomi have teased what appears to be a liquid camera lens for the upcoming Mi Mix phone. <http://dgit.in/apr21-13>



Apple gobbling up AI firms

Apple was the leading AI acquirer between 2016 and 2020, in order to improve Siri. <http://dgit.in/apr21-14>

Teardown: Xiaomi Mi 11

Packed with cutting-edge hardware

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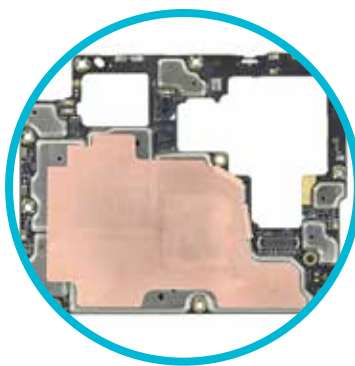
Prying open the Mi 11

The rear glass opens up rather easily with iFixit's iOpener kit and unlike numerous modern-day glass sandwiches, it isn't much of a nuisance to loosen the Mi 11's adhesive and pry it open. The Mi 11 doesn't have an official IP rating, so that could be a factor in the ease of opening the device. Next, a few Philips screws need to be loosened and removed to make for the extraction of the wireless charging coil.



Examining the camera modules

With the top layer out of the way, you can see three camera modules but only two visible connectors to unplug. Once those are unplugged, you see the third one hidden underneath the other two. The phone houses a 1080-megapixel Samsung ISOCELL Bright HMX sensor alongside a 13MP ultrawide lens and the brand new 5MP telephoto lens (Samsung S5K5E9). There's also a 20-megapixel selfie camera. The Mi 11 does forgo a typical telephoto lens in favour of the telephoto lens, so there's no optical zoom.



Copper-shielded silicone

The motherboard of the Mi 11 isn't difficult to remove and pops off pretty easily when removing the cameras. However, the motherboard has to be removed even if you're just getting the camera modules repaired, which is slightly aggravating. The silicone boards are covered by heat-dissipating copper and graphite foils. At the bottom right, you have three coax connectors, each colour-coded for error-free reassembly.